

Syed Fazil Basheer

Senior Software Engineer — Ruby on Rails, integrations & data movement

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• Coimbatore, India

Twelve years building and running Rails applications. Recent work concentrates on integrations with systems I do not control — **webhook ingestion, idempotent receivers, and migrations that cut over without downtime**. Five years at Donorbox, two as engineering manager; now back to building full time.

EXPERIENCE

Jun 2026 —
present

Software Engineer / Gameday

- Self-hosted Rails product for recurring football groups, built to production standards rather than as a business. Reconciles UPI payments to players through **one idempotent ingestion endpoint that fails closed**, behind an append-only delivery audit log.

Jun — Jul 2026
contract

Contract Software Engineer / Movement

- Designed and shipped the **\$mvt JavaScript SDK**, the authoring surface creators call from code blocks, and **snapshot-tested its signatures so re-typing a method breaks CI**, not just renaming it.

Jan — Mar 2026
contract

Contract Software Engineer / Rate My Leads

Integration pipelines and lead scoring. Second-largest contributor as an outside contractor.

- Built **webhook ingestion for Intercom, Close.io and Airtable** end to end — signing keys to normalised events feeding a shared immutable event log — verifying HMAC signatures and timestamps and storing credentials encrypted.
- Made **every receiver idempotent with idempotency keys** so retries and overlapping deliveries are safe; persisted raw webhooks on receipt and normalised afterwards, so a parser bug never loses an event.
- Migrated the LLM layer off a hand-rolled client **across eleven sequenced deploys, dual-writing through the cutover** so scoring never went down. **97 merged PRs in ten weeks**.

Apr 2025 — Apr
2026
1 yr

Software Engineer / OMR Report

Assessment analytics SaaS. Built, sold and supported solo, then acquired by Graavitons.

- Built a Crystal/Python/Ruby image pipeline reading smudged and photocopied answer sheets, **orchestrated as idempotent jobs that retry each stage independently**; made the field-block finder 11× faster.
- Designed a **provider-agnostic strategy layer** over Claude, OpenAI, DeepSeek, Gemini and local Ollama, parsing responses that carry prose outside the JSON fence rather than failing extraction.

Jul 2020 — May
2025
4 yr 11 mo

Donorbox

Engineering Manager Feb 2023 — May 2025 **Team Leader** Sep 2021 — Jan 2023 **Developer**
Jul 2020 — Aug 2021

- Built and maintained the **nonprofits database** — periodic scraping of official government sources across many countries plus the organisations' own sites — with change monitoring that reduced churn.
- Reimplemented the **signup flow** to cut steps and dropoffs, tailored per country from that database, and hardened the backend against fraudulent signups. Ran a multi-year i18n programme that opened European markets.
- Hired and managed data engineers and analysts; engineered **secure, private SQL generation from natural language** so data requests no longer queued. Mentored juniors on Ruby, Rails, Git and Minitest.

Aug 2019 — Jun
2020

Senior Developer / Kuvera

Digital gold, equity and loan-against-security for an investment platform.

- Built the referral rewards engine **reentrant and idempotent so a restart never paid twice**, dry-runnable to validate output without side effects, and trackable with step-by-step logs and skippable steps.
- Shipped RESTful APIs with controller tests and **API Blueprint documentation**; inherited request objects for third-party APIs (Augmont, Razorpay). Built Equity and LAS as **Rails Engines** on a shared Orders model.

Nov 2018 — Jul
2019

Developer / Code Astra

- Built back-end systems and the front-end interactions on top for Ally, an OKR product later acquired by Microsoft.

TECHNICAL

CORE	Ruby, Ruby on Rails, JavaScript, TypeScript, Hotwire (Turbo/Stimulus)
INTEGRATION	REST APIs, webhooks, HMAC verification, idempotency keys, OAuth, rate limiting, retries and backoff, SDK design
DATA	PostgreSQL, SQL, data modelling, query profiling and indexing, data migration, deduplication and reconciliation
TESTING & OPS	Minitest, RSpec, Playwright, fixtures, CI gates · Docker, Kamal, Redis, background jobs, audit logging

EDUCATION

2011 — 2015

Metallurgical Engineering & Materials Science **did not complete** — Indian Institute of Technology Bombay, admitted through the IIT-JEE.